

EXAMINED

Shanling MO

The zero in the Shanling MO's model number denotes its lightweight, minuscule build. The MO packs a lot into its tiny frame, starting off with an impressive frame itself. A singular volume-power combo button handles all through a combination of clicks. There are two ports at the bottom, one USB-C for USB DAC functionality, another 3.5mm standard. On the left, you have the micro-SD slot that supports up to 512GB of external memory. There's two-way Bluetooth connectivity on board as well, through Bluetooth 4.1. In terms of compatibility, it supports DSD, FLAC, DSF, DXD, AIFF and for wireless, it supports LDAC and aptX too. Trust us, that's a lot of features for its size and price. The display is a 1.54-inch touchscreen that is quite colourful and capable, and the display curves around the edges, which feels smooth. The MO has an aluminium unibody with a matte finish.



The UI is well thought out with simple horizontal swipe gestures and big, bold icons. The only problem would be if you have big hands and fingers, in which case using the Shanling MO might be a lost cause. There's no manual equaliser, which is understandable given

the screen size. Instead, you get a number of presets that you can choose from. The settings let you control numerous features around your playback like channel balance, gapless playback and more. The device claims a 15-hour battery life on its 640mAh battery and the performance does stand up to the claim. The ESS 9218p DAC chip performs superbly and the power output is pretty good for most portable gear out there, except for big, demanding headphones. The audio performance of the MO is clean, with good presentation on bass and mids, and slightly relaxed treble that still retains its presence. Overall, it leans towards warmth, which makes it suitable for a large audience. The bass is not particularly high resolution but maintains its clarity and doesn't bleed into the mids. When it comes to the mids, the MO holds its ground and reproduces good tonality and vocals. The highs are a bit lacking in detail, but that also keeps the MO away from harshness and shrillness, something that can be particularly irritating in DAPs trying to boost the treble. Overall, for the price it asks, the MO is superbly built, feature packed and performs well. We'd recommend this to anyone with an active lifestyle looking for a good audio source for their IEMs.

Kindle

Yes, this is the one that Amazon conveniently does not attach a version name to. Makes it very easy for anyone to explain which Kindle they have. Sarcasm apart, Amazon has just given its entry-level e-reader an upgrade with a front light, and also bumped up the price. This is the cheapest Kindle you can get with a light, so that's something it has going for itself. It is



currently selling at ₹7999 on Amazon, which is ₹2000 jump from the older base model. It comes with a six-inch glare-free screen with 167 ppi display and 'updated' e-ink technology. According to Amazon, this Kindle is capable of better contrast than its predecessors. It works on capacitive touch, which prevents accidental swipes. There's 4GB storage onboard and Wi-Fi for connectivity. Amazon also claims that the design has been upgraded to make it easier to grab, but it still looks pretty similar to its 2016 predecessor. Remember, the Paperwhite and the Oasis come with crisp 300 ppi displays, so there's a marked difference that you notice with this one. It is actually thinner by 0.4mm but at the same time, it is 13 grams heavier. According to Amazon, a single charge lasts up to four weeks, based on a half hour of reading per day with wireless off and the light setting at 13. The screen is still recessed from the edges, and the device is still not waterproof, the only device in the current lineup not to support it. There are pre-order offers available at the time of writing which give you your first book free (up to ₹200) as well as a two year extended warranty at ₹1200. The devices will start shipping on April 10. Throw in an additional ₹1,499, and you can pick a woven fabric cover as well.